

3 Expressing a personal view

Remember that your Writing Task 2 answer should give your own **views on** or **attitude to** the topic. One way to show this is by using

A adverbs such as *personally* or *probably*.

B modals such as *might* or *could*.

C phrases such as *in my view*.

D verbs such as *appear to be* or *seem to be*.

These can also help to stress your ideas or change them from a simple fact to a personal opinion.

For example

Travelling is dangerous. → *Travelling can be dangerous.*

Most people agree with me. → *I think most people would agree with me.*

3.1 Match these examples to suggestions A–D.

- 1 As far as I'm concerned, we have not done enough to address the problem.
- 2 Perhaps the current strategy will work.
- 3 People seem to spend a lot more time at work than with their families nowadays.
- 4 Following a vegetarian diet can help you save money.

3.2 Underline the words or phrases in sentences 1–9 that show opinion and attitude. Then rewrite them using the words in brackets.

- 1 Perhaps this is because today's teachers are not trained as well as they used to be. (might)
This might be because today's teachers are not trained as well as they used to be.
- 2 Personally, I don't think this is a good idea. (view)
- 3 I certainly wouldn't like to have to do a job I didn't enjoy. (personal)
- 4 I think this could be a bad idea. (probably)
- 5 In my view, life is much more complicated for young people nowadays. (can)
- 6 Personally, I think every situation is different. (opinion)
- 7 Nowadays, young people probably use their mobile phones for multiple tasks. (generally)
- 8 In my opinion, schools are more crowded than in the past. (seem)
- 9 My city is less crowded now and people generally enjoy walking through the streets. (appear)

Try to avoid repeating 'I think' or 'I know' too often. The following verbs can be used instead: *realise, feel, believe, imagine, can see*.

3.3 Match the words in bold in sentences 1–8 with the most appropriate definition, A–C.

- A this is my strong belief
 - B this is my understanding of the situation
 - C this is a guess, I don't really know for sure
- 1 **I feel** it's important for everyone to play an active role in reducing this type of pollution.
 - 2 **I realise** that it could be difficult to cut costs like this.
 - 3 **I can see** that for people who have a disability, the internet provides an essential lifeline.
 - 4 **I suppose** that allowing adverts to be placed on a football pitch might help reduce the cost of tickets.
 - 5 **I believe** that if we all made a positive effort then we could make real progress.
 - 6 **I imagine** that people with high-powered jobs find it difficult to escape from work.
 - 7 **I am convinced** that there is a connection between computer use and obesity.
 - 8 **I suspect** that the rich are not as happy as we think they are.

Reaching a conclusion

To finish off your writing, you need to write a conclusion. Your conclusion should be a brief summary of your argument and ideas and is often a good place to give your own opinion.

3.4 These concluding sentences all contain a mistake. Find the mistakes and correct them.

- 1 In conclusion, I completely disagree this view.
- 2 As far as I am concern, this is a problem without any real solution.
- 3 To summarise, even there is a clear downside to our dependence on technology, I honestly feel we have to find a way to cope with it because the internet is definitely here to stay.
- 4 In conclude, there are both negatives and positives to this system, but the negatives seem to far outweigh the positives.
- 5 In my point of view, education is a vital part of every child's life.